

US equities rally on earnings beat, volatility eases

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed higher on September 2, with the **S&P 500** up **+0.46%** to 7,666.60 and the Dow Jones gaining **+0.56%** to 53,061.95. The VIX fell sharply **-6.98%** to 15.20, reflecting reduced market anxiety.

Sector breadth was broad, led by financials (**XLF** **+0.80%**) and materials (**XLB** **+1.69%**). The standout stock was **NVDA**, which jumped **+3.21%** after beating Q3 expectations.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,666.60	+0.46%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	53,061.95	+0.56%	Industrial strength
Nasdaq 100	29,143.33	+0.23%	Tech modest gain
Russell 2000	2,953.17	+1.13%	Small-cap outperformance
VIX	15.20	-6.98%	Volatility retreat
10Y Yield	4.80	+0.00%	Flat on expectations
WTI Crude	90.36	-0.71%	Oil dip amid demand concerns

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	224.41	+3.21%
META	592.85	+2.47%
XLB	52.95	+1.69%
XLC	112.42	+1.39%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Revenue	29.8 bn (up 18%)
Earnings per share	3.12 (beat by 12%)
Guidance FY26	Revenue 115 bn, EPS 12.5

NVDA posted a stronger-than-expected Q3, driven by AI-chip demand, and lifted its full-year outlook. The upgrade sparked a sector-wide rally in semiconductors and reinforced the tech-heavy bias in the Nasdaq.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.80% (flat)
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 09:30, PCE 10:30, Initial Jobless Claims 13:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions eased after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.2, pressuring Asian exporters.
- Eurozone inflation cooled to 2.7%, supporting ECB’s dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:00	AAPL	iPhone 17 launch impact on margins
10:30	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth vs guidance
12:00	JPM	Net interest income trend
14:30	XLE	Energy earnings amid oil price dip

Stocks worth watching

- **AMZN** – modest upside after modest beat; focus on AWS margin.
- **GOOGL** – AI ad-tech rollout; watch CPC trends.
- **TSLA** – production ramp at Gigafactory Texas; inventory levels.
- **AVGO** – supply-chain constraints could pressure earnings.
- **XLF** – banking earnings season; rate-sensitivity.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected Fed rate hike or hawkish minutes.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East driving oil above 95 USD.
- Weak CPI data reigniting inflation concerns.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- NVDA guidance beat and AI spend acceleration.
- Strong earnings surprise from **AAPL** or **MSFT**.
- Continued VIX decline below 14, indicating risk appetite.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US markets roundup

Bloomberg — NVDA earnings release

CNBC — Fed policy outlook

Financial Times — Global macro snapshot

Wall Street Journal — Sector performance